ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapters 1–9: **A Letter to God (First Flight), The Proposal (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** dramatic irony	A wish granted in a harmful way.
2	**(c)** a symbol of acceptance of democracy by former opponents	Symbolic reading.
3	**(c)** internal conflict	The fight is within his mind.
4	**(c)** shows a girl growing in self-awareness	She reflects on herself.
5	**(a)** sensory and nostalgic detail	Memory images.
6	**(c)** a source of comic understatement and character revelation	It shows character and fuels humour.
7	**(d)** turning point	The cow incident changes the mood.
8	**(c)** therapeutic	It heals through insight.
9	**(c)** formal purpose and petty behaviour	Dignity versus pettiness.
10	**(b)** The ingratitude is the source of irony and shows human flaws	Defence of authorial choice.
11	**(d)** public ceremony to private reflection to universal message	Structural analysis.
12	**(b)** the black plane's sudden appearance and the radar's blank	The guide appears when he is lost but leaves no trace on radar.
13	**(d)** intimacy	A friendly address.
14	**(d)** organised, large-scale cultivation	Planned plantation.
15	**(b)** adapted to life in and near water	Adaptation.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	It stresses the ripe corn and Lencho's hope for rain (1) so that the loss feels larger by contrast (1).	1+1
17	He calls it a victory for justice and human dignity (1), so it is about right and wrong, not merely about power (1).	1+1
18	The seagull learns he is capable of flight (1) once he acts despite fear (1).	1+1
19	Naming creates a relationship (1) and turns a notebook into a confidante who 'listens' (1).	1+1
20	Bread is everyday yet central to festivals (1) so the baker links ordinary life with tradition (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	Strength: it gives hope after ruin (1). Weakness: it makes him expect help without question (1). It causes him to misjudge the people who help (1).	1+1+1
22	He says to be free is to respect others' freedom (1). If some remain oppressed, the whole society stays unfree and unjust (1). Hence freedom is collective and interdependent (1).	1+1+1
23	The ledge above the sea provides danger (1). The wide sea signals freedom and fear (1). The setting makes the leap a physical and emotional climax (1).	1+1+1
24	It states why she writes (1). It states to whom she writes (1). It also reveals her character and need, making it a thesis for the whole diary (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He recalls the baker's routine fondly (1). Sensory details recreate childhood (1). Nostalgia reveals sadness at change (1).	1+1+1
25	Affection motivates the journey and ensures good care (1). Yet the animal's welfare required better safeguards (1). The incident shows love needs prudence to be responsible (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Valli wants to be treated as an adult (1). 'Madam' fulfils her wish (1). The story shows it is natural and healthy (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers

2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	Lencho is the protagonist who suffers (1). The postmaster takes the decisions and acts (1). His kindness drives the plot (1). Lencho's faith inspires but the postmaster delivers (1). Conclusion: both essential, the postmaster is the moral hero (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Mandela is humble in sharing credit (1). He is courageous and defines true bravery (1). He offers forgiveness instead of revenge (1). He sets a vision of a just society (1). Overall, his words and life together show leadership guided by moral values (1).	2+2+1
27	Flight is the setting; fear is the theme (1). Most of the story is about hesitation (1). The leap is the climax (1). Flying is the proof that fear was unreal (1). The title suggests a beginning (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening defines diary as a friend (1). Kitty as listener (1). She records feelings, not facts (1). The Keesing story shows a lively mind (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapters 1–9: **A Letter to God (First Flight), The Proposal (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** the moving bus	Movement and travel.
2	**(d)** told her directly	Direct statements would fail.
3	**(c)** comic effect	Exaggeration.
4	**(d)** gullible	Gullible.
5	**(b)** inseparable	Cannot be divided.
6	**(b)** had not followed	Third conditional.
7	**(b)** The incorrigible boy never stopped teasing.	Describes a person who cannot be reformed.
8	**(a)** traditions passed down	Inherited culture.
9	**(d)** Splashing happily, Mij flooded the floor.	Correct participial phrase.
10	**(d)** had not seen	Third conditional.
11	**(a)** had found	Third conditional.
12	**(d)** Never had Lomov felt so nervous.	Inversion after 'never'.
13	**(a)** Lencho trusts the unseen God but doubts the people who actually help	Core paradox.
14	**(d)** He aims at reconciliation, not revenge	Constructive approach.
15	**(a)** simile	'like' compares.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	The animal is removed from its natural home and exposed to stress (1), yet the author's care and affection partly offset the concern (1).	1+1
17	'Madam' honours Valli (1) while the idea of a child as 'Madam' is gently comic (1).	1+1
18	She seeks life for her son (1) but her search proves death is everywhere (1).	1+1
19	Delay creates comic tension (1) and lets the quarrels reveal character (1).	1+1
20	To preserve Lencho's faith (1) and to give the story its ironic end (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	It is indirect and respects her feelings (1). It lets her reach the truth through experience (1). It may fail if the sufferer refuses to try (1).	1+1+1
22	Two quarrels drive the plot (1). They reveal temperaments (1). The resolution comes only after exhaustion (1).	1+1+1
23	The postmaster's act is central (1). The readers admire him (1). The story gently asks us to help without asking for thanks (1).	1+1+1
24	A walk suggests slow patient endurance (1). A battle would suggest violence, which Mandela's reconciling tone avoids (1). Walk also implies steps taken by many together (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It appears when he is lost (1). It leads him to safety (1). It can thus represent hope or guidance in despair (1).	1+1+1
25	The writer chooses what to record (1). Entries can be short or reflective (1). So the narrative shows her mood, not a full history (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It leaves a lasting picture (1). It shows scale of tea estates (1). It connects dialogue to scenery (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	Mosaic means separate pieces forming a pattern (1). Goa, Coorg, Assam (1). Different themes (1). No full coverage (1). Overall impression of unity in diversity (1).	2+2+1

	OR: Mij teaches Maxwell patience through chaos (1). He shows that play is a form of intelligence (1). He reveals the nature of otters (1). He tests assumptions about control over nature (1). Thus Mij educates his owner and the reader (1).	2+2+1
27	Plot is simple (1). Message of growth (1). Use of symbols (1). Emotional impact (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Denial in Kisa Gotami (1). The search as a method (1). Realisation of universality (1). Sermon's lines on grief (1). Peace and compassion (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapters 1–9: **A Letter to God (First Flight), The Proposal (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** millions have read them	Her diary became world famous.
2	**(d)** statement about the baker's wealth	A fact in the text's picture.
3	**(c)** love for an animal versus the animal's wild needs	Core dilemma.
4	**(d)** keeping cultural flavour and tone	Cultural nuances.
5	**(a)** retelling for modern readers	Retelling.
6	**(c)** single setting, small cast, unity of action	Compactness.
7	**(b)** justify Lencho's desperation	It earns sympathy.
8	**(c)** It addresses oppressed and oppressor alike	Inclusivity.
9	**(b)** multiple interpretations	Readers decide.
10	**(b)** a formal heading and subject line	Diary entries do not use subject lines.
11	**(a)** respectful	He values heritage.
12	**(d)** respect and patience, not force	Moral.
13	**(b)** traces a character's growth	Growth of the protagonist.
14	**(a)** the search for a death-free house shows death everywhere	She seeks life and finds universal death.
15	**(c)** Characters quarrel over meadows and dogs when love is at stake	Pettiness.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	It combines memories of Mandela's boyhood (1) with a public message to the nation and world on freedom (1).	1+1
17	He is a trained pilot (1) but exhaustion makes his perception doubtful (1).	1+1
18	She felt no one would be interested (1) yet the world now reads it (1).	1+1
19	It shows pride in a distinct identity (1) and blends myth with history (1).	1+1
20	They react with fear and alarm (1), showing that ignorance breeds anxiety (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	It leaves the reader with an image of happiness (1). It confirms that Mij is at home with Maxwell (1). It balances earlier tension with relief (1).	1+1+1
22	She behaves like an adult (1). She is easily shaken like a child (1). Thus she is between two worlds (1).	1+1+1
23	Both lose something precious (1). Lencho turns to God for restoration (1). Kisa Gotami turns to the Buddha and learns acceptance (1).	1+1+1
24	Land could become a property dispute online (1). Dogs could be replaced by gadgets or social media rivalry (1). The theme of ego stays the same (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Although he lost his crop, Lencho kept his faith (1). He lost his crop but he kept his faith (1). Complex has a dependent clause, compound has coordinated clauses (1).	1+1+1
25	If people had united, apartheid would not have lasted long (1). This is the third conditional for an unreal past (1). Verb forms: had united / would not have lasted (1).	1+1+1
	OR: I stood on the cold ledge, my heart hammering (1). Below, the sea roared and my family wheeled in the sky (1). I wanted to join them but my wings felt too weak (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks

26	Characters reflect real traits (1). Quarrels show pettiness (1). Property and marriage satirised (1). Laughter invites reflection (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: He acted promptly (1). He used his salary and friends (1). He could have sent more or explained (1). But then the faith would be shaken (1). Judgement: his choice is wise given the situation (1).	2+2+1
27	He feared pain, prison and death (1). Yet he continued to resist apartheid (1). In jail he stayed firm for 27 years (1). He faced his enemies with forgiveness (1). His life proves that courage is chosen action despite fear (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Continue from landing (1). New clue found (1). Pilot reacts (1). Mystery deepened or solved (1). Neat ending (1).	2+2+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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